

# Matthew Benko

(989) 395-1760 | benkomatt@gmail.com | linkedin.com/in/matthewbenko/  
github.com/BenkoMatt | credly.com/users/matthew-benko

## SUMMARY

Information Security Engineer with hands-on experience in security monitoring, incident response, and threat analysis across enterprise environments spanning healthcare, energy, and manufacturing industries. Skilled in EDR alert triage, email phishing analysis, forensic sandboxing, and security event correlation. Experienced in Active Directory security administration, conditional access policy enforcement, and security awareness training. CEH, CompTIA Network+, A+, and AWS CP certified. Holds a Master of Science in Information Security & Intelligence with a minor in AI & Penetration Testing from Ferris State University.

## INFORMATION SECURITY WORK EXPERIENCE

### Reed City Group

Jan 2025 – Present / Reed City, MI

#### IT Security Engineer

- Monitored and triaged ESET Protect EDR alerts across 250+ endpoints, performing necessary threat assessments, containment, and remediation
- Conducted forensic analysis and sandboxing of suspicious files, attachments, and URLs using VirusTotal and AnyRun to identify malicious indicators and correlate attack patterns
- Reviewed and analyzed email phishing attacks through KnowBe4 Defend Email Threat and Barracuda Email Gateway Defense systems, documenting findings and response actions in case tracking
- Reduced the attack surface of targeted phishing campaigns by 80% by implementing conditional access policies in Microsoft 365 Admin, requiring site-wide multifactor authentication, role-based session limits, and 3rd party data access permissions
- Improved incident response time and reduced access control issues by 200 hours annually through a segregated Microsoft Active Directory system based on department & job role inside Windows Server 2019, enforcing Principle of Least Privilege
- Cut 70-90% of spam and malicious emails by managing both KnowBe4's Defend Email Threat system and Barracuda's Email Gateway Defense system
- Spearheaded the Security Awareness Training program by designing and executing department-specific simulated phishing campaigns to train employees on common tactics and techniques found in real-world phishing attacks
- Conducted security awareness orientations for all new hires, communicating security concepts to non-technical audiences
- Developed Python scripts for automated data extraction, alert correlation, and security reporting tasks
- Automated Active Directory-KnowBe4 user synchronization for security training compliance tracking
- Collaborated extensively with the Pathfinders IT MSP in quarterly security audits, providing alert and incident data for review

### Consumers Energy

May 2024 – Jan 2025 / Jackson, MI

#### CX&T-Security Intern, GRC Team

- Led the transition of enterprise risk management systems, migrating ~5,000 registered IT and infrastructure risks while ensuring data integrity and system availability
- Worked with networking, systems, and application teams to identify and document network, access, and infrastructure-related risks during project planning phases
- Gained hands-on exposure to large-scale utility IT environments supporting 24/7 uptime and continuous security monitoring operations

### Hurley Medical Center

July 2021 – Aug 2021 / May 2022 – Aug 2022 / Flint, MI

#### Senior Information Technology Extern

- Processed and resolved 300+ IT service tickets, including network connectivity, workstation, and hardware issues in a high-availability healthcare environment
- Led and trained new IT extern hires on ticket workflows, troubleshooting, and IT best practices
- Collaborated with IT teams across networking, systems administration, biomed, database management, and application analysis

## CERTIFICATIONS, LICENSES, & AWARDS

EC-Council Certified Ethical Hacker (CEH) / CompTIA Network+ (Net+) / CompTIA A+ (A+) / AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner (AWS CCP) / FCC HA Technician (KF8ACL) / Michigan CPL Holder / Red Cross First Aid/CPR/AED / Zehnder's Employee of the Month (July 2023) / Ferris State University President's Scholarship

## EDUCATION

### Ferris State University

Big Rapids, MI

**Master of Science:** Information Security & Intelligence

May 2026

**Bachelor of Science:** Information Security & Intelligence

Dec 2024

Postgraduate Certificate: Business Intelligence / Incident Response / Info. Sys Assurance, Strategy, Governance

Minor: Artificial Intelligence & Penetration Testing